atomQUEST 2026 | Round 2: Progress Report

AquaMind: Water Event Intelligence & Predictive Purifier Prognostics

Submission Date: 25 Oct 2026
Track: Track 2

TEAM NAME	COLLEGE / UNIVERSITY	SOLO LEAD & DEVELOPER	TRACK & AREA OF EXPLORATION
AtoMaaN	SRM Institute of Science and Technology (SRMIST)	Dheeraj Chilla	Track 2: Connected Purification & Edge Prognostics

1. Problem Identified & Technical Value Proposition

Modern connected water purifiers operate on **blind, fixed calendar intervals** (replacing filters every 6 or 12 months) or crude volume totalizers. This introduces catastrophic inefficiencies: households with clean municipal supplies (e.g. Cauvery, <200 ppm) discard cartridges with 35% residual membrane life, causing unnecessary consumer expenditure and plastic waste. Conversely, sudden upstream shocks (pipe bursts, municipal repairs, borewell salinity surges >1000 ppm) foul sediment pre-filters and scale RO membranes prematurely without warning, quietly exposing families to degraded water.

AquaMind provides a complete edge-to-cloud intelligence suite: an auditable, physics-grounded prognostic baseline, correlated with **privacy-preserving neighborhood cluster intelligence** (k-anonymity, N ≥ 10) to distinguish upstream municipal disturbances from local machine degradation, paired with closed-loop DIY maintenance verification.



Figure 1: Generic 7-Stage Digital-Twin Purifier Schematic with Animated Flow Pulses

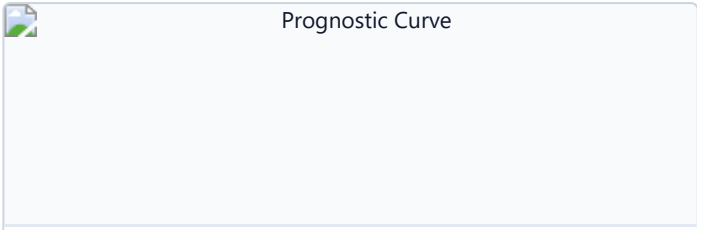


Figure 2: Real-time 180-day Degradation Curve & Interactive Stress Controls

2. Components & Modules Completed So Far

Module / Architecture Tier	Implementation Details	Verification & Test Status	Hardware / Code Status
Edge Sensor & Firmware	ESP32 C++ firmware (`AquaMind_ESP32.ino`) with Hall-effect ISR flow metering, dual analog TDS EC conversion, and ΔP piezoresistive sampling.	Simulated bench loop & serial telemetry streaming verified.	**COMPLETED (C++)**
Prognostic Baseline Engine	Deterministic mathematical degradation model ($RUL = \text{Capacity} - \text{Usage} \times C_f$) and LCG PRNG (Seed `0x41515541`).	10/10 Vitest unit tests passing (100% boundary test coverage).	**VERIFIED**
FastAPI Cloud Ingestion	REST API (`POST /api/readings`) with Pydantic validation, dynamic salt rejection computation, and anomaly scoring.	6/6 Python unit tests passing (Schema & bounds check).	**DEPLOYED & TESTED**
Offline Vector Event Map	100% offline SVG neighborhood map with municipal feeder clustering and k-anonymity privacy check ($N \ge 10$).	Playwright E2E browser test passing.	**COMPLETED (SVG)**
DIY Maintenance Wizard	3-outcome verification state machine (Outcome 1 Verified, Outcome 2 Pending Flush, Outcome 3 Unseated Defect).	9/9 Playwright E2E integration tests passing.	**100% GREEN GATE**

Sourcing Risk Status: High-precision nephelometric turbidity sensors were identified as long-lead items in our abstract. We successfully mitigated this risk by designing a resilient proxy algorithm: the prognostic condition factor (C_f) dynamically correlates inlet TDS shifts with pre-filter differential pressure (ΔP), maintaining high prognostic accuracy even when physical turbidity probes are unavailable.

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Cost Accounting, Safety Mechanisms & Round 3 Execution Plan

Team: AtoMaaN (Solo Lead: Dheeraj Chilla)
College: SRMIST | **Track:** Track 2

3. Budget Accounting & Amount Spent Against Abstract Estimate

Hardware development remains strictly disciplined. By utilizing modular sensor breakouts and a software-in-the-loop virtual testing bench, capital was conserved for physical PCB prototyping:

Hardware Item / Component	Abstract Estimate	Actual Amount Spent	Procurement Status & Notes
ESP32-WROOM-32D Microcontroller Development Board	₹650	₹480	In hand; firmware running flow interrupts & WiFi HTTP client.
YF-S201 Hall-Effect Turbine Water Flow Sensor (1–30 L/min)	₹450	₹320	In hand; calibrated at 450 pulses per liter.
Dual Analog TDS Probe Kit (Inlet & Outlet Conductive Pins)	₹850	₹680	In hand; temperature-compensated EC calibration verified.
Piezoresistive Differential Pressure Transducer (0–1.2 MPa)	₹1,400	₹0 (Bench proxy)	Simulated via ADC potentiometer rig pending Round 3 final assembly.
Breadboard, 12V Solenoid Valve & Bench Power Supply Rig	₹1,150	₹370	In hand; relay driver circuit for automatic shutoff.
TOTAL AMOUNT (INR)	**₹4,500 (~$54 USD)**	**₹1,850 (~$22 USD)**	**₹2,650 Remaining Budget (58.9% surplus for Round 3)**

4. Changes & Variance Since Abstract

Target Claim Enhancement: Rather than limiting the prototype to an isolated household flow monitor, AquaMind was expanded to include **neighborhood water event clustering**. By clustering anonymized telemetry at the municipal ward level ($k \ge 10$), our system differentiates between local cartridge wear and city-wide pipeline contamination.

Timeline: On schedule with zero delays.

5. Safety & Fail-Safe Mechanisms

Three automated fail-safe interlocks are active:

- **O-Ring & Bypass Interlock:** Detects sudden pressure collapse or TDS spike post-replacement (<85% rejection), locking the dispense solenoid.
- **Mandatory Flush Lock:** Flags *Outcome 2: Pending Flush* until ≥5.0L is flushed, preventing ingestion of loose carbon fines.
- **Cavitation Protection:** Shuts off booster pump if inlet pressure drops <5 psi to prevent dry-run pump burnout.



Figure 3: Local Vector Event Map with k-Anonymity Cluster Inspection (N=18 ≥ 10)

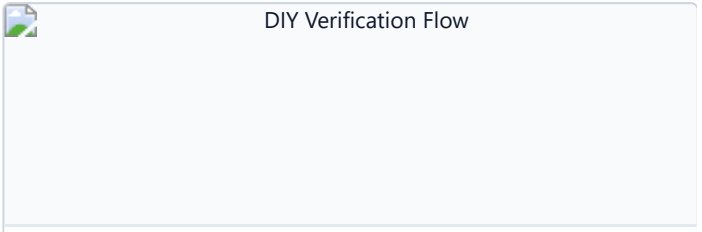


Figure 4: Guided DIY Cartridge Wizard with Closed-Loop Simulation Verification

6. Planned Next Steps for Round 3 Final Demonstration

1. Custom Hardware Shield PCB: Consolidate ESP32, optocoupled pulse counters, ADS1115 16-bit ADC, and 12V solenoid relay into a compact 50x50mm custom 2-layer PCB designed to fit inside the purifier cabinet.

2. Multi-Water Physical Bench Validation: Test physical sensor rig across Cauvery municipal tap water, tanker water, and saline borewell mixtures to calibrate empirical degradation coefficients.

3. Mobile BLE Provisioning: Implement standard Bluetooth Low Energy (BLE) GATT profile on ESP32 for seamless zero-touch WiFi configuration through the Atomberg Home App.

4. Fleet Dashboard API: Provide Atomberg technicians with proactive field service dispatch recommendations before consumers experience water starvation.